

The Well-Child Visit

One checklist for any age. Every item adapts to the child in front of you — relying on a caregiver for a preverbal child is the correct behavior.

Part 1 of 2

History & surveillance

● = core item

A. OPENING & HISTORIAN

- ☐ **Hand hygiene, name and role ●**
Wash or say so; give your name and role.
- ☐ **Who is giving the history ●**
Who's answering, and how much they see.
- ☐ **Adapt to developmental level ●**
Ask the child what they can answer; caregiver the rest.
- ☐ **The family's own agenda ●**
"What's on your list today?" — before yours.

B. INTERVAL & CURRENT STATE

- ☐ **Since the last visit ●**
Illness, injury, urgent care, anything new.
- ☐ **Any concern today**
Anything going on right now, apart from the visit?
- ☐ **What is usual for this child**
This child's current normal, not the textbook's.

C. GROWTH & DEVELOPMENT

- ☐ **Growth as a trajectory ●**
Read the curve over time. One percentile doesn't count.
- ☐ **Development or function for age ●**
What they can do now — vs. their own baseline if known.
- ☐ **Any skill lost or function lost ●**
Ask explicitly. A clear no is a complete answer.
- ☐ **Their own concern about the child**
"Anything that worries you?" — open-ended.

D. NUTRITION

- ☐ **A typical day of intake, with amounts ●**
Usual intake is enough; not a full recall.
- ☐ **Food security**
"Is there always enough food?" Ask every family.

E. ELIMINATION, SLEEP & ROUTINE

- ☐ **Elimination and sleep ●**
One broad question can cover both.
- ☐ **Activity, screens and daily routine**
Appropriate to the age in front of you.

F. BEHAVIOR & EMOTIONAL HEALTH

- ☐ **Behavior, temperament or mood ●**
In the terms the age calls for.
- ☐ **Emotional / mental health screen for this visit**
The domain the schedule calls for at this age.

G. MEDICAL BACKGROUND

- ☐ **Past and current conditions ●**
Screen broadly; characterize a positive.
- ☐ **Serious illness, hospital, ED or surgery**
One screen covers all four. If no, stop.
- ☐ **Medications — and beyond prescriptions ●**
OTC, vitamins, supplements, remedies. Both halves.
- ☐ **Allergies — and the reaction ●**
Medication, food, environmental. If none, stop.
- ☐ **Birth history**
Deep in infancy, brief later.

H. FAMILY & SOCIAL CONTEXT

- ☐ **Household and other caregivers ●**
Who lives at home; who else has the child.
- ☐ **School, childcare or work ●**
Where the day is spent, and how it goes.
- ☐ **Family medical history ●**
Atopy, seizures, learning problems, inherited disease, childhood death.
- ☐ **Supports, and how the caregiver is doing**
Ask the person in front of you how they're doing.

The Well-Child Visit — Part 2

Environment, preventive care, anticipatory guidance and closing.

Part 2 of 2

● = core item

I. ENVIRONMENT & EXPOSURES

- ☐ **Smoke, vape, substance exposure ●**
Household exposure at every age; the patient's own use in adolescence.
- ☐ **Housing, lead risk, environment**
"Childproofed?" is not enough — lead needs home age, paint or renovation.
- ☐ **Safety at home: the interpersonal screen ●**
"Does everyone at home feel safe?" Not the same as poisons or firearms.

K. IMMUNIZATIONS & SCREENING

- ☐ **Check the record against the schedule ●**
What's been given, what's due, flu shot, anything deferred and why. "Up to date" is a claim, not a check.
- ☐ **The screening due at *this* visit ●**
Name or order it. Recognizing a screen is due is the skill.
- ☐ **Dental home, vision, hearing**
The non-vaccine preventive care the age calls for.

M. CLOSING

- ☐ **Invite questions — and answer them ●**
"What questions do you have?" then respond, or say how it'll be answered.
- ☐ **What happens next, and when to return**
Today's plan, the next visit, or what to watch for and when to call.

L. ANTICIPATORY GUIDANCE

Scored on what you **said to the family**, not on what you asked. One meaningful piece per item is enough.

- ☐ **Safety guidance for the age ●**
Injury prevention that fits this child's stage.
- ☐ **Nutrition or feeding guidance ●**
One concrete, age-appropriate recommendation.
- ☐ **Development, behavior or sleep guidance**
Anything in this domain that fits the age.

- ☐ **Tailor guidance to something *this* family said ●**
The quality item. Perfect, complete, age-appropriate guidance that connects to nothing the family raised scores zero. Name their own words back to them, answer the question they asked, or address what they disclosed.

HOW THIS IS SCORED

Yes or no, nothing between. 38 items, one point each. No partial credit, and each item credits once.

The transcript is the evidence. A concept counts when it was said — by you or by the patient/caregiver.

Parts 1 and 2 report separately. A strong history with generic guidance shows up as exactly that.

Negative screens are complete. Where the checklist says "if no, stop," a clear no is a full answer — don't pad.

THREE WAYS STUDENTS LOSE POINTS

1. Reading a single percentile instead of the growth trajectory.
2. Asking "any medicines?" and never reaching vitamins, drops or remedies.
3. Delivering flawless guidance that has nothing to do with this family.